



LONG-TERM GOALS Sunjoy Dhaawan, Vice President of Human Resources, DHL Express (India)

ment believes will lead to greater customer satisfaction.

To begin with, unlike most other logistics firms, DHL Express relies heavily on providing comfort to its front-line workers by offering them air-conditioned four-wheelers for last-mile deliveries, instead of two-wheelers, as is common in the sector. According to Dhaawan, this, coupled with a dedicated driver and automated scanning machines, not only reduces stress on the front-line workers but also helps the company retain talent.

Following the global standards on bringing diversity in its workforce, the firm has grown the share of women employees in the workforce by one percentage point each in the past three years. Dhaawan says the target is to increase the share of women employees to 25 per cent by 2027 and to 40 per cent in the long run. A change in perception about the logistics sector and the overall societal and economic factors in recent years make him confident about achieving this target. “Five years ago, to get women to do logistics jobs was difficult. But in the last three years, we have made decent progress on that front,” he says, explaining how DHL Express has grown its share of women employees. Also, of seven professionals in top management, two—its chief financial officer and the head of customer service—are women.

That’s not all. The firm is also trying to attract a younger workforce. “We ensure that we are not only geographically diverse, but also culturally. Because we believe a multi-generational organisation will be able to assimilate and work together. That’s how you get differ-

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	Top attributes
● Clarity of company goals ● Flexibility at work ● Growth and learning opportunities	

ent perspectives on the table and that is healthy for an organisation... [so that it is able to take the correct] decisions,” says Dhaawan. While the average age of employees is 37 years now, it may come down later, he reasons.

DHL Express also ensures it grooms its managers well. The importance of direct line managers is immense in implementing its “respect ahead of results” approach and its principle of keeping the workforce motivated. The firm has a certified international manager programme in place to not only groom future top leaders but also to ensure that first line managers are dedicated towards implementing the firm’s four pillars. With these measures in place, DHL Express is confident of continuing its success in managing people. **BT**

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